



DESIGN SYSTEM • V1.0

Sentinel

A complete visual language for a file intelligence application.

Does this reduce cognitive load?

You work across legal, graphic design, AI, home renovations, photography, software, and business. That's a huge mental load already. Sentinel shouldn't add to it — it should reduce it.

Every design decision, every pixel, every animation must pass one test: does this make the user's life simpler? If the answer isn't yes, it doesn't ship.

Five words.

01

Calm

No urgency unless there's a reason for it.

02

Precise

Every element earns its place on screen.

03

Trustworthy

You can trust what you see. No ambiguity.

04

Fast

Keyboard-first. Zero friction between thought and action.

05

Quietly Powerful

Depth is there when you need it.

Flashy Futuristic Gamer Hacker — We can hint at these, but never become them.

Our constitution.

Principle 01

Information First

Every screen answers one question: "What's the most important thing I need to know right now?"

No decorative widgets. No filler.

Principle 02

Colour Has Meaning

If we use colour, it communicates something. Green is ready. Amber is review. Red is action required. Blue is in progress.

Never decorative. Always semantic.

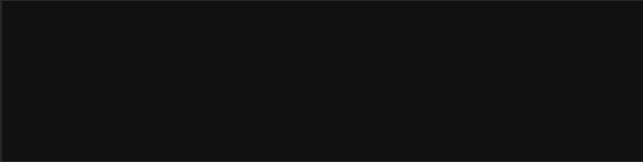
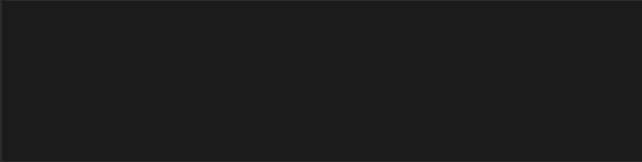
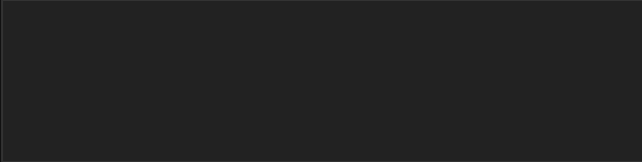
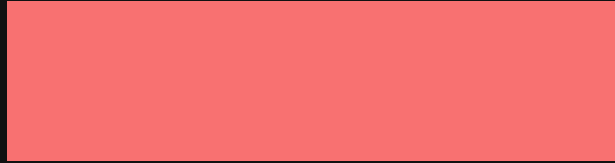
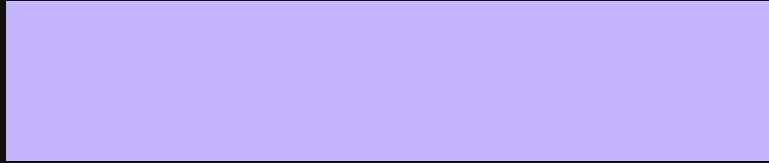
Principle 03

Motion Has Purpose

Nothing animates just because it can. Scan progress, cards updating, sidebar expanding — these earn motion.

No bouncing buttons. No constant glow.

Semantic colour.

Surfaces			Text	
				
BACKGROUND	PANEL	CARD	PRIMARY	SECONDARY
#111111	#1A1A1A	#222222	#FFFFFF	50% White
Semantic			Accent	
				
READY	REVIEW	ACTION REQ.	IN PROGRESS	LILAC
#34D399	#FBBF24	#F87171	#60A5FA	#C4B5FD

Two fonts. Only two.

Display + Interface

SF Pro

Everything the user reads. Navigation, labels, descriptions, body text.

Sentinel

Dashboard

Organise your digital world with clarity and precision.

Data + Status

SF Mono

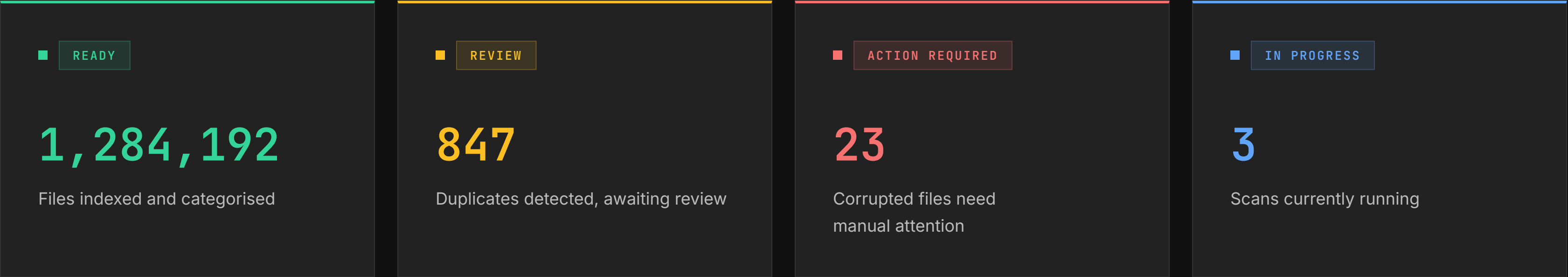
Anything that represents data. Counts, timestamps, statuses, file paths.

READY

1,284,192 FILES

SCAN COMPLETE · 13:42:01

Colour is language.



Colour is never applied decoratively. Every instance communicates a specific system state. If a colour appears, the user can trust its meaning.

Eight primitives.

#	COMPONENT	PURPOSE
01	Status Card	System state at a glance
02	Metric Card	Single numeric value + label
03	Action Button	Primary and secondary actions
04	Section Header	Area labels with optional actions
05	Activity Log	Timestamped event stream
06	Progress Bar	Scan and task completion
07	Sidebar Item	Navigation with state indicator
08	Terminal Output	Raw data and scan results

Live Mockup

FILES

48,291

STATUS

READY

SCAN PROGRESS

87%

Start Scan

Settings

ACTIVITY

13:42:01

Scan complete

13:41:58

847 duplicates

13:40:12

Indexing /Users/Photos

Speed without friction.

Navigation

SHORTCUT	ACTION
⌘ 1	Home
⌘ 2	Analyse
⌘ 3	Organise
⌘ 4	Reports

Actions

SHORTCUT	ACTION
⌘ K	Command Palette
Space	Preview selected file
⌘ ⇧ F	Search everything
Esc	Close / back

Principle

Almost everything can be done without the mouse.

The fastest path between thought and action should never require reaching for a trackpad.

The Observatory.

Not a shield. Not a weapon. An observatory — quietly watching everything, noticing patterns, keeping order, and helping you navigate complexity.

Option A

Shield

Protection & trust

Option B

Radar

Awareness & discovery

Option C - Selected

Observatory

Clarity & perspective

Less about defending against problems, more about giving you clarity and perspective over your digital world.



LOGO USAGE

One mark, three contexts.

Primary · On Dark



Default usage. App UI, dark contexts.

Secondary · On Light



Print, light backgrounds, external docs.

Monochrome · White



Where colour isn't available or appropriate.

Logo Colour



#34D399

RGB (52, 211, 153)

Don't

-  Stretch or distort the wordmark
-  Use off-brand colours
-  Add effects, shadows, or outlines
-  Place on busy backgrounds

Dashboard

LAST SCAN · 13:42:01

New Scan

⌘K

TOTAL FILES

1,284,192

ORGANISED

98.2%

DUPLICATES

847

SPACE SAVED

24.7 GB

CURRENT SCAN · /USERS/DOCUMENTS

IN PROGRESS · 73%

RECENT ACTIVITY

- 13:42:01  Scan complete – 48,291 files processed
- 13:41:58  847 potential duplicates detected
- 13:40:12  Indexing /Users/Photos/2024
- 13:38:45  Classification complete – 12 categories
- 13:35:20  AI analysis started
- 13:30:00  Scheduled scan initiated

NEEDS ATTENTION

23 CORRUPTED FILES

Manual review required

847 DUPLICATES

Review and merge

Purpose, not decoration.

Approved Motion

✓ Scan progress increasing

Linear fill, 200ms ease-out

✓ Cards updating values

Counter transition, 300ms

✓ Sidebar expanding

Width transition, 250ms ease

✓ Reports appearing

Fade in, 200ms

Prohibited Motion

✗ Buttons bouncing

Distracting, no information value

✗ Constant glowing

Creates visual noise, fights status colours

✗ Decorative transitions

Slows perception, adds no meaning

✗ Parallax or scroll effects

Desktop app, not a marketing site

10 categories. 42 subfolders.

```
sarah@local:~$ tree -d -L 2 ~/Sorted/
~/Sorted/
├─ Legal/
│   ├── Court-Documents/ · Contracts/ · Correspondence/
│   ├── Evidence/ · ID-Certificates/ · _Archive/
├─ Banking/
│   ├── Statements/ · Invoices/ · Receipts/
│   ├── Tax/ · Insurance/ · _Archive/
├─ Design/
│   ├── PSD-Source-Files/ · Exports/ · Branding/
│   ├── Mockups/ · Fonts/ · _Archive/
├─ Templates/
│   ├── Documents/ · Spreadsheets/ · Presentations/
├─ Screenshots/
│   ├── Desktop/ · Mobile/ · Screen-Recordings/
├─ Security/
│   ├── Passwords/ · Recovery-Codes/ · Licences-Keys/
├─ Media/
│   ├── Photos/ · Videos/ · Audio/ · GIFs-Stickers/
├─ Documents/
│   ├── Personal/ · Work-Business/ · Reference/ · Scans/
├─ Projects/
│   └─ {Project-Name}/ → Assets/ · Docs/ · Exports/
└─ Downloads/
    ├── Software/ · Archives/ · Unsorted/ # landing zone

// Every category has _Archive/ – underscore prefix sorts first.
// When a matter closes, archive instead of delete.
```

 Legal 6 subfolders · .pdf .docx .eml	 Banking 6 subfolders · .pdf .csv .xlsx
 Design 6 subfolders · .psd .ai .svg .fig	 Templates 4 subfolders · .docx .xlsx .pptx
 Screenshots 3 subfolders · .png .jpg .mp4	 Security 3 subfolders · .kdbx .txt .pdf
 Media 4 subfolders · .mp4 .mp3 .jpg .heic	 Documents 4 subfolders · .pdf .docx .txt
 Projects Dynamic · Assets / Docs / Exports	 Downloads 3 subfolders · Unsorted = triage

Naming & sorting rules.

Naming Convention

\$NAMING_FORMAT

YYYY-MM-DD_Category_Description_v1.ext

Examples:

2026-06-15_Bank_Westpac-Statement-June.pdf

2026-06-20_Legal_Affidavit-Supporting-Court.docx

2026-06-22_Design_Logo-Final_v3.psd

2026-06-25_Tax_BAS-Q4-2026.pdf

2026-06-28_Receipt_JBHiFi-Laptop.jpg

RULE	RULE	RULE
No spaces — use hyphens	Date first for chronological sort	_v1, _v2 for versions. _FINAL once

Automated Sorting (Two-Pass)

PASS 1

Extension-Based

.psd .ai .indd .fig → /Design/PSD-Source-Files/

.otf .ttf .woff → /Design/Fonts/

.exe .dmg .msi → /Downloads/Software/

.mp4 .mov .avi → /Media/Videos/

.mp3 .wav .flac → /Media/Audio/

.kdbx .1pux → /Security/Passwords/

PASS 2

Keyword-Based

"statement" "westpac" → /Banking/Statements/

"invoice" "bill" → /Banking/Invoices/

"receipt" → /Banking/Receipts/

"affidavit" "court" → /Legal/Court-Documents/

"contract" "NDA" → /Legal/Contracts/

"screenshot" "snip" → /Screenshots/Desktop/

80+ extension rules · 100+ keyword tags · Ambiguous files (.pdf, .docx, .jpg) resolved by keyword pass.

Five phases.

PHASE 1

Foundation

CURRENT

Project structure · Sidebar · Dashboard · Design system · Status cards

PHASE 2

Core Engine

File scanner · Progress updates · Folder statistics · Safe preview

PHASE 3

Organisation

File moves · Rules · Duplicate detection · Cleanup

PHASE 4

Intelligence

OCR · AI classification · Project relationships · Natural language search

PHASE 5

Automation

Scheduled tasks · Watch folders · Notifications · Reports



Sentinel Design System

Every screen we build from here will speak the same language. Calm, precise, trustworthy, fast, and quietly powerful.

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